

Discerning Mission

Discerning Mission	1
0. Purpose	2
1. Jesus' Commission	5
2. Historical Context	6
Biblical Origins	6
Historical Growth	6
3. Christianity and Ethnic People Groups	8
Who is Unreached vs Unchurched	8
4. Mission Strategies	10
Circumstances	10
Supernatural Factors Impacting Mission	10
Natural Factors Impacting Mission	10
Perspective	13
Strategy classifications	14
Standard-Solution	15
Being-in-the-Way	15
Plan-So-Far	15
Unique-Solution	15
5. Mission Organisations	17
CMS (Church Missionary Society)	17
SIM (Serving in Mission)	17
Pioneers	17
Interserve	17
OMF (Overseas Missionary Fellowship)	18
6. Training and Maintaining	18
Preparing	18
Going	19
Staying	19
Leaving	20
7. Personal Assessment: Circumstances and the "CMS 10"	21
8. What next?	22
Conclusion	24
Appendix	24

Potential 10/40 Countries.....	24
Beyond-9 Monitoring Regime.....	1

I want to thank God.

I want to thank my mentors of faith, the Ministers & Missionaries of St Mark's, my Parents, brothers and sisters in Christ who have pointed me to the Pioneer and Perfector of Faith, Jesus.

I have highlighted the points I would like to prioritise discussing further. I am open to your insight, whether on this subject matter or elsewhere. You are not obligated to read my ramblings. Any assistance is greatly appreciated.

Date: 16/09/2026

Disclaimer: Bible Passage Retriever¹ and the NIV Bible Gateway² are the selected biblical referencing tools. The usage of Generative Artificial Intelligence extends up to resourcing but not including the composition of this document. The style of this document is limited by my lack of non-technical writing training. Consequently, limited historical and theological enquiry skills should be reasonably excused. My desire for a nuanced understanding of Mission is likely limited by over-dichotomisation. The functional purpose of this document is to take precedence over its form.

0. Purpose

This document outlines the process sought to discern personal involvement in Mission. It integrates biblical foundations, global missiological research, and personal circumstances, seeking to go beyond mere influences and reactions. Discernment isn't intended to find all the answers but ground an understanding of mission through first principles and identify questions to discuss with wise and experienced Christians. Doing so assists in taking the next steps for God.

Faithful understanding and obedience of God's word requires sensitivity to its human context and divine revelation. Knowing God through his word shapes the understanding of his world and how one ought to live for him.

As for you, you were dead in your transgressions and sins, in which you used to live when you followed the ways of this world and of the ruler of the kingdom of the air, the spirit who is now at work in those who are disobedient. All of us also lived among them at one time, gratifying the cravings of our flesh and following its desires and thoughts. Like the rest, we were by nature deserving of wrath. But because of his great love for us, God, who is rich in mercy, made us alive with Christ even when we were dead in transgressions—it is by grace you have been saved. And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus, in order that in the coming ages he might show the incomparable riches of his grace, expressed in his kindness to us in Christ Jesus. For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of

¹ <https://marketplace.visualstudio.com/items?itemName=timmy-braun.bible-passage-retriever>

² <https://www.biblegateway.com/>

God— not by works, so that no one can boast. For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do.

Ephesians 2:1-9

God's love is such an undeserved gift. This gift of salvation, though not entitled to anyone by works, commissions all people to do good works.

Oh, the depth of the riches of the wisdom and knowledge of God!

How unsearchable his judgments,

and his paths beyond tracing out!

"Who has known the mind of the Lord?

Or who has been his counselor?"

"Who has ever given to God,

that God should repay them?"

For from him and through him and for him are all things.

To him be the glory forever! Amen.

Romans 11:33-36

The sharing the gospel, to family, friends, and the world, vocationally or not, is a privilege. Sharing the Gospel for the glory of God is the life Christians have been given to live; only from him, through him and for him. Doing so does not entitle anyone credit from God, nor does it make them his counsellor, nor get anyone any closer to grasping the full depth of the riches of the wisdom and knowledge of God.

Be merciful to me, O God, be merciful to me,

for in you my soul takes refuge;

in the shadow of your wings I will take refuge,

till the storms of destruction pass by.

I cry out to God Most High,

to God who fulfills his purpose for me.

He will send from heaven and save me;

he will put to shame him who tramples on me. Selah

God will send out his steadfast love and his faithfulness!

My soul is in the midst of lions;

I lie down amid fiery beasts—

the children of man, whose teeth are spears and arrows,

whose tongues are sharp swords.

Be exalted, O God, above the heavens!
Let your glory be over all the earth!
They set a net for my steps;
my soul was bowed down.
They dug a pit in my way,
but they have fallen into it themselves. Selah
My heart is steadfast, O God,
my heart is steadfast!
I will sing and make melody!
Awake, my glory!
Awake, O harp and lyre!
I will awake the dawn!
I will give thanks to you, O Lord, among the peoples;
I will sing praises to you among the nations.
For your steadfast love is great to the heavens,
your faithfulness to the clouds.
Be exalted, O God, above the heavens!
Let your glory be over all the earth!

Psalm 57

This Psalm's context is David depending on God as he flees Saul. All Christians should depend on and take refuge in God. He fulfills his purposes for his people, not the other way around. I want God's glory to be all over the earth, so I want to praise God among the nations. God does not depend on me; I depend on him.

The biblical distinction between Christians who lead are led (EPH 6:5-9) demonstrates that every legitimate vocation can be exercised under Christ's Lordship. Whether leading an organisation or working under another's authority, all Christians are called to faithful stewardship of the gifts God has provided. This applies to Christians in vocational ministry and the secular workplace.

Three principles provide a framework for discerning vocational ministry:

- The Open Word: Scripture is the authoritative foundation for determining what is true and good.
- Jesus as Fulfilment: The Great Commission shapes how ordinary activities, including work, relationships and professional skills, are directed towards Christ.
- Love-Guided Action: Biblical wisdom is applied to particular circumstances, seeking the good of others and the glory of God.

This means that vocational decisions should be evaluated not solely according to personal ability or opportunity, but also according to character, Christian convictions, the needs of others and the purposes of God.

The consideration of God's goodness and my identity as a Christian directs my desires to be a missionary, though I am open to other opportunities. A missionary is a disciple of Jesus who makes disciples of Jesus where Jesus isn't yet known³. The desired outcome of Discerning Mission is to proceed in the most suitable direction for a life in ministry, whether in mission or not.

1. Jesus' Commission

Prior to The Great Commission: God created everything (GEN 1), people sinned (GEN 3), God made promises (GEN 12), God died to pay the debt of our sin and was raised from the dead (JHN 3:16). This is what he said before he ascended:

Then the eleven disciples went to Galilee, to the mountain where Jesus had told them to go. When they saw him, they worshiped him; but some doubted. Then Jesus came to them and said, "All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, and teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you. And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age."

Matthew 28:16-20

This is the conclusion of Jesus' ministry and the commissioning of his followers. There are many responses to Jesus' identity claims prior and to the commission following this moment. Jesus' fulfillment of God's promises demonstrates his authority as:

- the one whom all peoples on earth are blessed (GEN 12:1-4, MAT 1:1-2),
- the one who blesses as the servant (ISA 49:1-6, MAT 20:20-28),
- the Son of Man (DAN 7, MAT 5, MAT 8, MAT 24, MAT 26),
- God (JHN 1)

God commissioned his followers:

Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, and teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you. And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age."

Some elements that are notable to discerning Mission include:

- The element "Of all nations" ("πάντα τὰ ἔθνη") focuses on the sharing of the gospel within and between different people groups "ἔθνη" rather than merely nation states. Paul's use of his freedom (1 COR 9:19-23) can be understood in context of this panethnic need for all efforts being used so that all people groups know Jesus Christ as Lord.
- Jesus said "name" not "names" in "the name of the" ("τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ"). This instates Trinitarian baptism and is echoed by the Apostles with Jesus as the mediator (ACT 2:38, ACT 10:48, ACT 19:5).

³ <https://dmcollective.org/training/>

- The teaching of and the obedience to God's will continues through the power and presence of Jesus through his Spirit (JHN 14:12-18).
- All Christians are witnesses to Christ and are commanded to share the gospel to all people until the very end of the age when Jesus returns (ACT 1:1-11).

These are some of the fundamentals of mission that the apostles then and many disciples since have lived out. For the prospective gospel worker, this biblical grounding ensures that the desire for ministry, specifically mission, is rooted in God's desires rather than anything else.

The goal of mission: evangelise, disciple, plant churches, develop leadership, and exit to partnership⁴, is one that I want to commit to. By knowing God, his will, and the world's need of salvation, a holistic perspective of all people groups can be formed.

2. Historical Context

Biblical Origins

The global context of the Christianity's movements between and growth within people groups facilitates a holistic understanding of the current state of unreached people groups.

Prior to his ascension, Jesus said to his disciples:

But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.

Acts 1:8

The disciples knew the *Missio Dei*: what the Gospel is, how it is to be shared, and who it is to be shared with (MAT 28:16-20). Understanding the disciples as Jews in Roman Jerusalem can inform some missiological principles⁵. Their context is significant because it reveals the relationship they had with the places and people groups they ministered to. This is demonstrated in the spread of the Gospel:

- The disciples started sharing with who they knew no matter where they came from (Jerusalem ACT 2). They were depending on God's spiritual provision of the Holy Spirit.
- The disciples continued into the surrounding familiar region (Judea ACT 1-7).
- They ministered to the people whom they despised (Samaria ACT 8-12).
- They ministered to the people who are very foreign to them (to the ends of the earth ACT 13-28).

Historical Growth

Jesus' commission is obeyed by the apostles as they preach in the synagogues and the Pagan temples; first to the Jew then to Gentiles. The Apostle Paul's letters aren't just

⁴ <https://www.imb.org/the-missionary-task/>

⁵ <https://www.workingpreacher.org/commentaries/revised-common-lectionary/ascension-of-our-lord/commentary-on-acts-11-11-10>

epistles from himself to the churches he planted. Through proper understanding of the context, Christians can understand them as God's word to all Christians. All gospel workers are God's workers, all people are God's field, and the growth is only from him, through him and for him (1COR 3:4-15, ROM 11:33-36).

The separation from Judaism and the distinction from false religions occurred within the context of Jerusalem Council (49/59 AD) (ACT 15), orienting of Christians focus on Jesus as the high priest (HEB 7), and The Fall of Jerusalem (70 AD).

The prominence of the early church cities (2nd and 3rd century) of Rome in Europe, Carthage in Asia and of Alexandria in Africa predicated differences in organisation and doctrine. Throughout their growth within institutional persecution (Diocletian 305 AD) and legalisation (Constantine 313 AD), Christianity expanded beyond western civilisation.

Dale T. Irvin summarises in *"World Christianity: An Introduction"* (2008)⁶ that the spread of the Gospel was never exclusively Western. Major changes in the legality and unity of Christianity in the Roman Empire between the 1st and 5th century did not hinder its spread via trade routes to Africa (Egypt, Ethiopia), Asia, India, and Persia. It spread long before Christianity became a primarily European religion between the 8th and 12th century. Amidst Islam in West Africa, Portuguese Missions in the 15th century saw the growth of Christianity⁷. Admittedly, it must be noted that the erosion of Portugal's political power coincided with the decline of Christianity in those regions.

As summarised by the Stone Table⁸, the late modern waves of mission involved:

- Western Colonialism facilitated coastal missions (1700s, reaching and establishing port cities particularly in The Americas, Asia and Oceania)
- Inland missions (1800s, reaching the interior of continents like Africa and China)
- Unreached People Group focus (1970s-present, focusing on ethnolinguistic groups). This stems from the Lausanne Congress.

The Lausanne Movement came from the 1974⁹ Lausanne Congress on World Evangelisation, led by Billy Graham, bringing together Christian leaders from nearly 150 countries to promote global cooperation in evangelism. The Lausanne Covenant emphasised taking "the Whole Church to take the Whole Gospel to the Whole World", while recognising both evangelism and social responsibility and highlighting the significance of unreached people groups. Through subsequent congresses in Manila (1989) and Cape Town (2010), Lausanne has continued to connect Christians across the Global North and South in theological reflection and practical mission.

A discernment of mission informed by the historical context of Christianity around the world assists in the choice of mission organisation. This requires an understanding of:

- the proportion of Christians amongst ethnic people groups

⁶ <https://www.jstor.org/stable/10.5325/jworlchri.1.1.0001>

⁷ https://journals.co.za/doi/pdf/10.10520/AJA02562804_933

⁸ <https://www.thestonetable.org/what-is-missiology-and-why-does-it-matter-the-stone-table/>

⁹ <https://lausanne.org/global-analysis/lausanne-74>

- and the strategies used to reach non-Christians and equip Christians to share the Gospel.

3. Christianity and Ethnic People Groups

Who is Unreached vs Unchurched

Contemporary missionary efforts are needed where there is a significant remaining gap in gospel access and response. Significant gaps in gospel access are characterised by unreached people groups. They can be defined as¹⁰:

an identifiable group of people distinguished by a distinct culture, language, or social class who lack a community of Christians able to evangelize the rest of the people group without outside help.

Simply put, this is when less than or equal to 2% of the population is Evangelical Christian¹¹ and less than or equal to 5% Christian adherence. Above this threshold, church movements typically remain self-perpetuating within a group. Within Unreached people groups are Frontier people groups where 0.1% or fewer are Christian¹². Currently, 42.4% of the world's population lives in communities considered "unreached"¹³. If a mission's focus is primarily directed through such a broad sweeping numerical definition, the forecasting of local church perpetuation becomes arbitrary and people outside such a simplified definition become marginalised¹⁴. Thus, comprehensive analysis must be exercised beyond the one-size-fits-all metrics.

Significant gaps in gospel response are characterised by unchurched people¹⁵; those who can but don't go to church. The distinction between the usage of "people groups" and "people" in the two descriptions is underpinned by an understanding of globalisation and lack thereof. The lack of interdependence between different cultures is a challenging condition for the Gospel to be shared. Most of the people in this condition are unreached. Although people can still be unreached in globalised societies, unreached people most often exist in ethnically distinct communities.

This focus on the growth of Christianity within ethnic groups is in concordance with the [passages mentioned prior](#). Hence, a focus on the distribution unreached people groups according to ethnicity is a biblically faithful and strategic perspective for mission. Circumstances relating to local or diaspora communities within or between nations informs mission strategy. A significant geographic concentration (96%)¹⁶ of unreached people groups exists within the 10/40 Window. It is defined as a region bound by 10 degrees above,

¹⁰ <https://www.globalfrontiermissions.org/missions-101/the-unreached-peoples-and-their-role-in-the-great-commission#:~:text=an%20identifiable%20group>

¹¹ https://grd.imb.org/wp-content/uploads/documents/gsec-files/archive/gsec-overviews/2024-12_GSEC_Overview.pdf

¹² <https://joshuaproject.net/frontier>

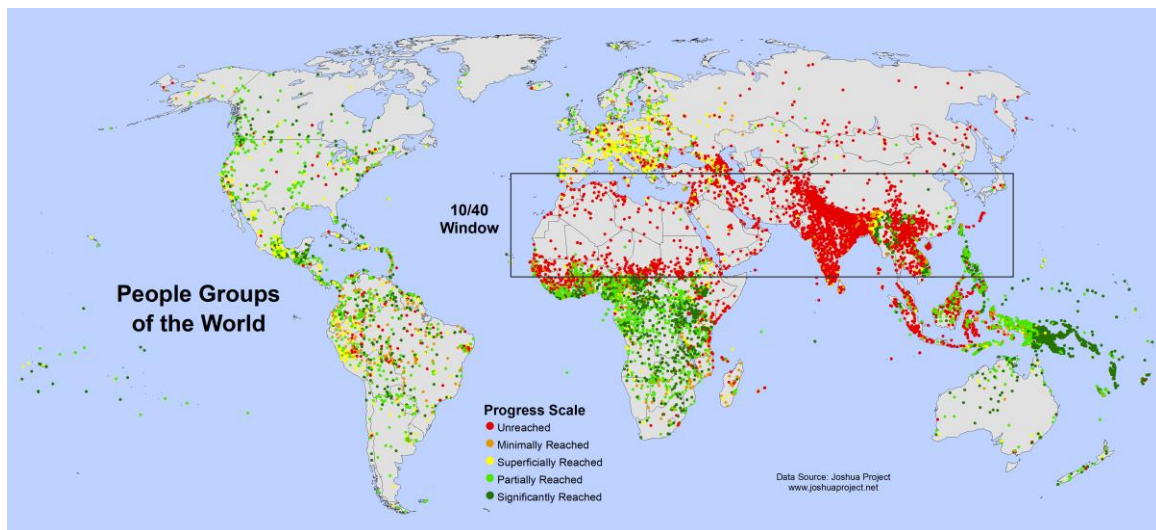
¹³ <https://notebook.google.com/notebook/4e0225a2-d675-44ca-b6d3-cc92cbcecfb7>

¹⁴ <https://www.imb.org/key-terms/#:~:text=It%20unnecessarily%20limits%20the%20%E2%80%9CUnreached%E2%80%9D>

¹⁵ <https://makingdisciples-resources.lcms.org/unchurched-2/>

¹⁶ <https://media.joshuaproject.net/public/assets/media/handouts/status-of-world-evangelization.pdf>

40 degrees below, spanning from West Africa to East Asia. The inclusion of some reached countries, such as Ethiopia and Korea, within this geographical window does not invalidate its definition and aim. An important feature of the 10/40 window is that less than 3% of missionary work is done among these people in this region¹⁷. This is not a matter of tunnel vision, but appropriately identifying urgent Gospel needs.



Data from the Joshua Project and the Gospel Project highlights the severity of the "unfinished task". There are key hotspots within the 10/40 window in Southern Asia. Home to the most UPGs (2,033)¹⁸, India has with 3 out of 4 people living in a frontier unreached group. Despite having half of the world's frontier UPG population, it receives less than 3% of global missionaries. It is amongst many countries with UPG and FPG greater than one million in size.

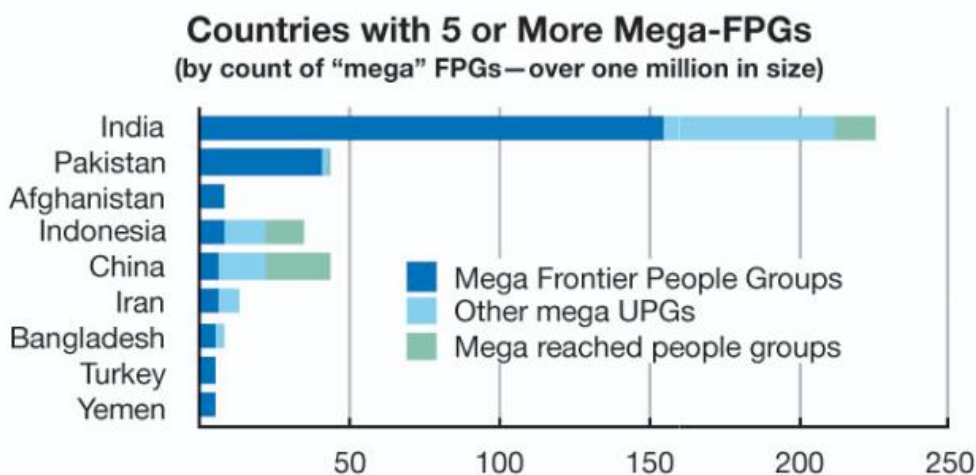


Figure 9: Top 10 Countries of Mega-FPGs. Based on data accessed May 2024 from [JoshuaProject.net/frontier/interactive](https://joshuaproject.net/frontier/interactive) Used with permission by RW Lewis.

19

¹⁷ <https://www.globalfrontiermissions.org/missions-101/the-unreached-peoples-and-their-role-in-the-great-commission>

¹⁸ <https://joshuaproject.net/countries/IN>

¹⁹ <https://media.joshuaproject.net/public/assets/media/handouts/great-progress-what-remains.pdf>

4. Mission Strategies

Circumstances

An understanding of the mission feasible circumstances informs the strategies of mission. The terminology of “one” in “if one can ___ then one could ___” is describing the teams accross mission field stations or mission fields.²⁰

Supernatural Factors Impacting Mission

Scripture describes a spiritual struggle against all that oppose God's will (EPH 6:12). This may include:

- Spiritual blindness or resistance to the gospel.
- Idolatry and deeply established religious systems.
- Fear, deception, and bondage to worldly beliefs (COL 2:8).
- Opposition and persecution against those who seek to share Christ.

The opposition to God's will does not thwart his plan. God raised up the Pharoah, hardened his heart, so that God's name may be proclaimed across the earth (ROM 9:14-18). It is particularly important to continuously remind oneself, according to Romans, that the salvation of anyone does not depend on human efforts but on God's mercy.

More reading in this area shall be prioritised.

Natural Factors Impacting Mission

The forms of the restriction on Christian activity or missionaries can either be social, economic, political, and/or religious extremist²¹. Many reasons can exist for these forms of restriction/resistance. A notable reason for people's resistance is the negative experiences with Christianity, particularly in the context of colonialism, which can create distrust. The restriction severity and the growth of Christianity is not binary or uniformly correlated in all mission fields. The following portrayal is a generalised representation of this reality.

Context Type	Low Restriction	High Restriction
Fast Growth	Kenya ²² , Nigeria, Peru ²³	China ²⁴
Slow Growth	Japan, The United States ²⁵	Afghanistan, Somalia, Yemen ²⁶

How do I know which group would I be suited to?

²⁰ <https://gotherefor.com/offer.php?intid=28925&changestore=true>

²¹ <https://www.eastwest.org/blog/spreading-the-gospel-in-restricted-access-nations/>

²² <https://www.thestonetable.org/what-is-missiology-and-why-does-it-matter-the-stone-table/>

²³ <https://sim.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Mission-Together-Issue-168.pdf>

²⁴ <https://www.persecution.com/globalprayerguide/china/>

²⁵ <https://cdn.omf.org/sg/files/20230622110853/Millions-Jan-Apr-2023.pdf>

²⁶ media.joshuaproject.net/public/assets/media/handouts/missions-top-ten.pdf

More information on the growth of Christianity in highly restricted regions can be found on the Voice of the Martyrs²⁷ and Open Doors²⁸ websites. The book "*The Varieties of Religious Repression: Why Governments Restrict Religion*" is intended to be read²⁹. If one can go there, one could move around there.

The most obvious impacting factor is geographical isolation. Remote mountains, islands, deserts, or difficult terrain can limit access. Improvements in transport technology and economic viability over the last century have reduced the limitations of geographical isolation. If one can move around there, one could stay there.

Poverty and limited resources, such as the lack of education, transportation, healthcare, and infrastructure can make long-term ministry challenging. If one can stay there, one can connect there.

Cultural and linguistic barriers can make communication of the gospel difficult. This is extensively documented on the Joshua Project. Amongst the unreached people groups, Hindi, Arabic and Bengali are the most spoken languages.

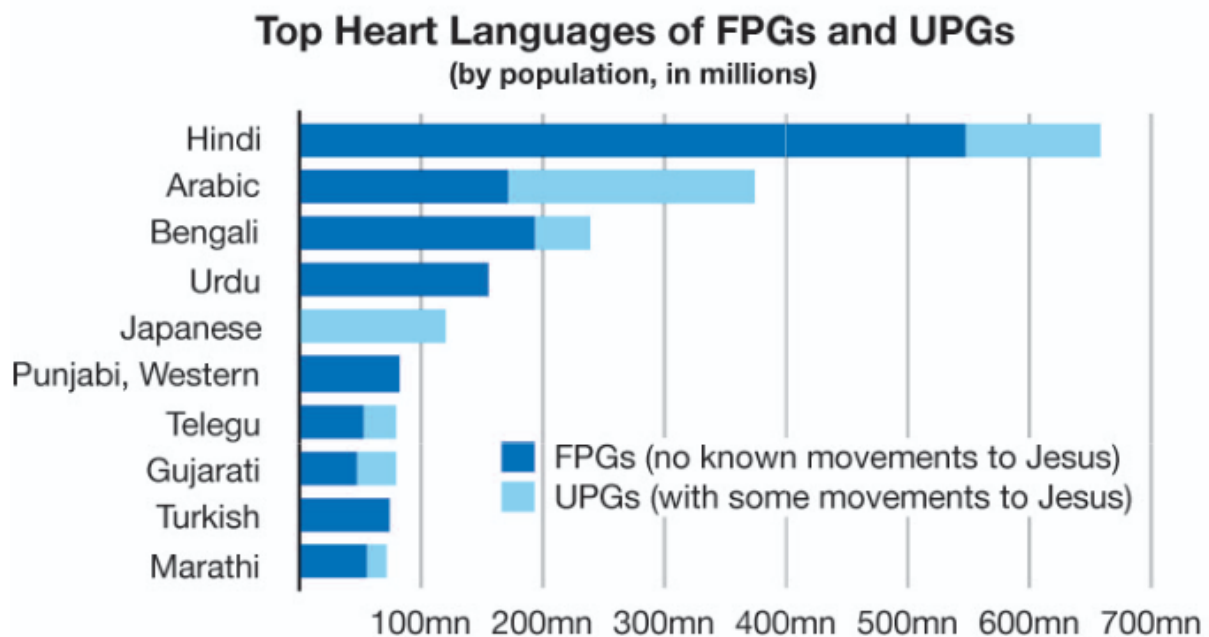


Figure 8: Top Languages of FPGs and UPGs. Based on data accessed March 2024 from [JoshuaProject.net/frontier/interactive](https://joshuaproject.net/frontier/interactive) Used with permission by RW Lewis.

Language barriers exist, whether that be lack of gospel workers who speak the language or lack of bible translation. "Low Language Viability" refers to languages that are rapidly disappearing, dying out, or shifting toward major national languages, making a dedicated, standalone Bible translation unfeasible or unnecessary³⁰. Consequently, the increase in the

²⁷ vom.org

²⁸ <https://www.opendoors.org/en-US/>

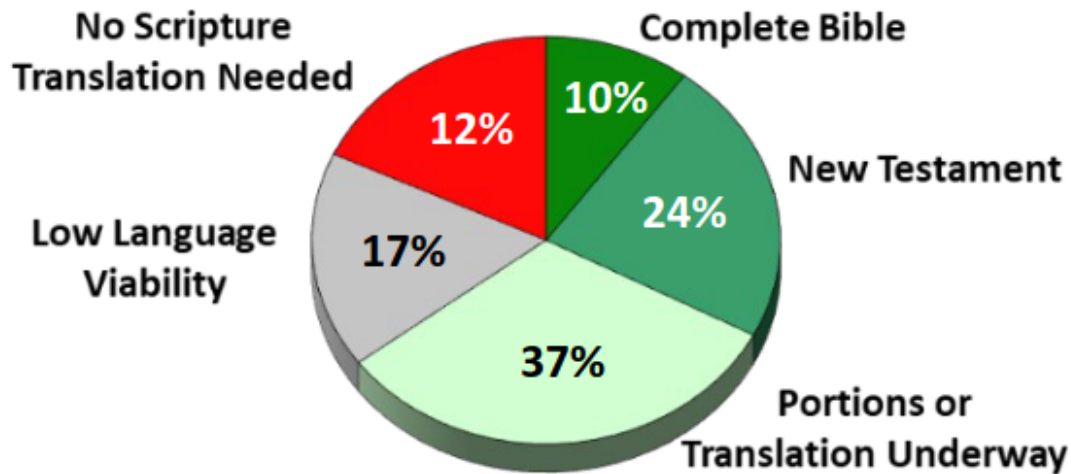
²⁹

https://books.google.com.au/books?id=XnabBQAAQBAJ&lpg=PP1&ots=_8dT_94WJN&dq=Governments%20may%20restrict%20Christian%20in%20different%20ways%20for%20different%20reasons.&lrpg=PR4#v=onepage&q&f=false

³⁰ <https://media.joshuaproject.net/public/assets/media/handouts/bible-translation-status.pdf>

number of primary languages with Bible translations reflects both ongoing translation work and the disappearance of languages that are no longer in use.

Languages: 7,395 (percentage of languages in the pie chart)

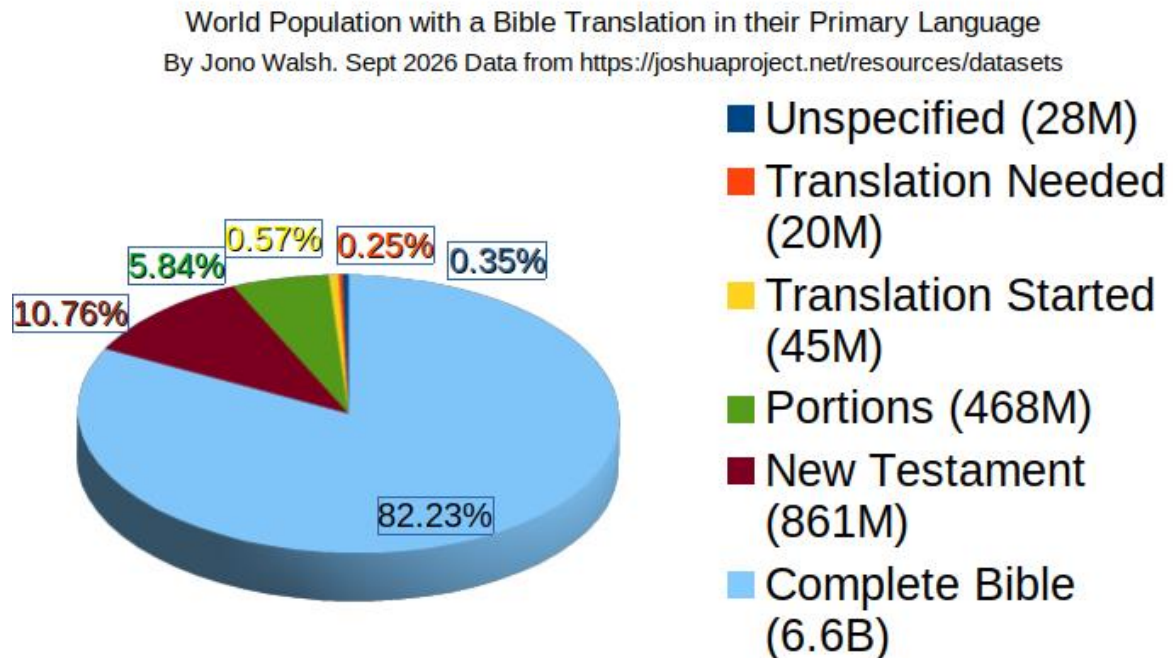


Scripture	Completed
■ Full Bible	771
■ New Testament	1,760
■ Portions or translation underway	2,772
■ Low language viability	1,271
■ Translation needed	821

31

Representing Bible translation status by the number of people who speak each language as their primary language better reflects gospel outreach progress among UPGs.

³¹ <https://media.joshuaproject.net/public/assets/media/handouts/status-of-world-evangelization.pdf>



³²The unspecified status indicates that a people group may speak an uncoded language or a dialect where formal registry data has not yet mapped cleanly to active translation agencies like Wycliffe^{33 34} or SIL³⁵. Grow Fast Grow Deep³⁶ assists in training gospel partners in English to be train and connect with international missionaries.

Beyond the census data on converts, spiritual growth amongst UPG could be defined and measured³⁷ using standards devised by the International Missions Board. Faithfulness Data indicates activities carried out by personnel and partners, including sharing the gospel, discipling believers, training leaders, and engaging people groups. Fruitfulness Data shows the results of these activities, including people receiving salvation through Jesus Christ and new churches being formed. Quantifying spiritual growth can assist in the identification of perpetuating churches. **This area requires further reading³⁸.**

A biblically oriented perspective of mission, informed by circumstances, is required prior to understanding strategies. If one can connect there, one could enact strategies to achieve God's purpose: evangelise, disciple, plant churches, develop leadership, and exit to partnership³⁹.

Perspective

Jesus testified that his Kingdom is not of this world, he is not conquering for a nation or a culture, but he has come to testify the truth (JHN 18:33-38). Because mission cannot be

³² <https://joshuaproject.net/resources/datasets>

³³ <https://wycliffe.org.au/>

³⁴ <https://www.wycliffe.org/>

³⁵ <https://global.sil.org/>

³⁶ <https://growfastgrowdeep.com>

³⁷ <https://www.imb.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/2025-IMB-Annual-Statistical-Report.pdf>

³⁸ <https://www.imb.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/2025-Annual-Statistical-Report-Definitions.pdf>

³⁹ <https://www.imb.org/the-missionary-task/>

devoid of culture⁴⁰, and Christianity is not for or against a culture, Christ focused inculturation is required. Inculturation, synonymous with contextualisation, refers to “the adaptation of church doctrine and ritual to unreached or non-Christian cultures”⁴¹. A disregard for inculturation is a neglect of the opportunity for more people to be saved through cultural interpretations of the Gospel (1 COR 9:19-23). Examples include ecclesial sensitivity to lifestyle⁴² and the translation⁴³ of the Bible into a language. Fundamentally⁴⁴, a cultural interpretation of the Gospel is the simple recognition of sin and how Jesus saves and the complex direction of spiritual needs identified in a culture to Jesus. Paul did this with the Athenians (ACT 17:16-34). No amount of inculturation should water down gospel truths, since it is the gospel that saves. It will continue to be seen as foolish to people who are not saved whether inculturation occurs or not (1COR 1:18).

Acculturation, imposing cultural archetypes in sharing the Gospel, has adverse consequences. In the spread of the Gospel, constraining an understanding of Christianity to just a Eurocentric perspective can result in the weaponisation of mission by colonial infiltrative power and the demonstration of no regard for inculturation. Some shortcomings of mission work in Australia can be taken as an example. The insistence of English culture’s superiority over Aboriginal culture, resulted in the misidentification of westernisation as spiritual growth⁴⁵ and the erasure of indigenous cultural identity^{46 47 48}. Additionally, constraining an understanding of Christian Mission to just European efforts disregard the efforts of non-European movements. Great sensitivity should be taken to not overgeneralise the cause and effects of mission trends. Even if the truth of Christ is preached in mission by harmful means or by false motives, Christians should rejoice that the truth is being shared (PHP 1:15-18).

Strategy classifications

To produce lasting fruit (growing disciples and self-sustaining local churches) sending churches, pastors, and candidates must evaluate these strategies in light of Scripture and global missiological realities. The four forms of mission strategies, as highlighted by John Mark Terry and J.D. Payne⁴⁹, can apply the perspective of inculturation.

⁴⁰ <https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/article/missions-approach-too-western/>

⁴¹ <https://www.gotquestions.org/inculturation.html>

⁴² Formation of meetings with consideration of “African time” https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/African_time

⁴³ see the notes regarding the translation of sin on pages 8 and 9

<https://www.jstor.org/stable/1185597?seq=8>

⁴⁴ <https://www.cms.org.au/stories/crossing-cultures-with-the-gospel/>

⁴⁵ Jane Lydon's *Fantastic Dreaming* (ISBN 9780759111042) analysed the Ebenezer Mission, She arguing that Moravian missionaries used Western material goods to measure the conversion and “civilisation” of the Wergaia people. Unfortunately, I can’t find an online copy of this.

⁴⁶ <https://sydneycathedral.com/news-blog/saying-sorry>

⁴⁷ <https://www.ijfmr.com/papers/2026/2/72592.pdf>

⁴⁸ <https://humanrights.gov.au/resource-hub/by-resource-type/bringing-them-home-reports/bringing-them-home-chapter-19>

⁴⁹ Developing a Strategy for Missions: A Biblical, Historical, and Cultural Introduction by John Mark Terry and J.D. Payne

<https://books.google.com.au/books?hl=en&lr=&id=JQD5AAAAQBAJ&oi=fnd&pg=PT7&dq=different+>

Standard-Solution

Treats a single, pre-packaged methodology, such as mass literature distribution or Western revivalism, as a universal solution across all cultural contexts⁵⁰. Overlooking critical differences in cultural worldviews, oral communication preferences, honour-shame dynamics, and local security restrictions hinders connection with the evangelised group. Christ's Great Commission targets distinct ethnolinguistic people groups (ethne) rather than uniform nation-states (MAT 28:19). Effective cross-cultural witness requires humble listening, language mastery, and context-specific engagement rather than exporting Western church patterns.

Being-in-the-Way

A core assumption is that human strategic planning interferes with divine sovereignty, prioritising absolute availability and spontaneous leading over formal long-range planning. This is historically reflected in early China Inland Mission strategies⁵¹. Whilst this type of strategy fosters deep, prayerful trust in God's provision ("By Prayer"), it risks neglecting human stewardship, organisation planning, and abdicating responsibility for the sake of immediate evangelistic presence. Though Scripture establishes that God's sovereign purpose prevails over human plans (PRO 19:21), God calls gospel workers to be faithful, intentional co-workers who plan wisely while relying entirely on the Holy Spirit (1COR 3:5-9).

Plan-So-Far

Focuses on initiating gospel activity, such as short-term outreach, tract drops, or medical clinics, without establishing long-term follow-up or discipleship structures. It is limited by defining success primarily by initial professions of faith⁵², leaving new converts without ongoing pastoral care, local church grounding, or leadership training. Increased accountability is often required⁵³. Jesus commanded His followers to make disciples by "teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you" (MAT 28:20). Authentic mission requires a long-term commitment that disciples' believers, integrates them into worshipping communities, and equips indigenous leaders to multiply (2TIM 2:2, ACT 14:21-23).

Unique-Solution

Recognises that every culture, language group, and political environment presents unique barriers requiring a tailored, prayerfully developed strategy. Its strength is in its flexibility. It evaluates historical methods to create flexible, context-appropriate platforms, such as Business-as-Mission (BAM)⁵⁴, medical services⁵⁵, or Discovery Bible Studies (DBS)⁵⁶,

[mission+strategies+christianity&ots=4skd167d0o&sig=HHt5UwkA_mxBdhXa1aNRybmHySI&redir_esc=y#v=onepage&q&f=false](https://www.missionstrategies.com/christianity&ots=4skd167d0o&sig=HHt5UwkA_mxBdhXa1aNRybmHySI&redir_esc=y#v=onepage&q&f=false)

⁵⁰ <https://cdn.omf.org/sg/files/20230622110853/Millions-Jan-Apr-2023.pdf>

⁵¹ <https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/themelios/review/encountering-china-the-evolution-of-timothy-richards-missionary-thought-1870-1891/>

⁵² <https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/article/still-cancel-short-term-mission-trip/>

⁵³ <https://ministrywatch.com/ywam-a-dynamic-movement-of-hundreds-of-ministries-but-not-an-organization/>

⁵⁴ <https://businessasmission.com/engineering-on-the-frontlines-what-is-it-really-like-to-run-a-bam-business/>

⁵⁵ <https://mercyships.org.au/>

⁵⁶ <https://novo.org/dbbs>

specifically adapted for unreached or restricted settings. Through this strategy, entire UPG communities can be engaged when the gospel is introduced into families and pre-existing communities, in home-based discipling movements⁵⁷. This mirrors Paul's contextual adaptability (1COR 9:22) and the incarnational principle of sharing the gospel in language, in lifestyle, and in resources to build genuine, self-sustaining movements.

Among the different strategies employed by the following organisations, BAM appears most relevant to how I desire to use my present and future skills for the glory of God. The operation of legitimate commercial enterprises allows Christian professionals to legally enter and reside in countries where traditional missionary visas are denied⁵⁸. A BAM addressing consumer or industry needs in a restricted country can simultaneously address spiritual needs.

For example, in Eastern and Southern Africa in 2024, with only 68% of the region's population had access to at least basic drinking-water services, falling to 53% in rural areas⁵⁹. The WHO identifies significant operational, technical and resource constraints among small water supplies⁶⁰. This creates opportunities for locally appropriate surveillance and control technologies, such as solar-powered systems for monitoring water levels, flow, pump performance, and selected water-quality indicators. There are many proven examples of BAM⁶¹, and there is immense potential in joining an existing BAM company^{62 63 64}.

This is an example of BAM that could address practical needs while creating opportunities for Christian witness. Contribution involves Human and Intellectual Capital⁶⁵ in the most apparent business operations. However, BAM at its heart depends on Spiritual and Social Capital, through prayer, pastoral and cross-cultural support, and relationships with local churches and partners (if they exist), as well as Financial, Infrastructural and Natural Capital to ensure that ventures are sustainable and responsibly managed. While BAM ventures do not need to be explicitly gospel-centred, they should operate consistently with Christian ethics⁶⁶. This would mean, for example, foregoing my interest in national-security surveillance technologies outside Australia where it could conflict with these principles. Whether through BAM or otherwise, I would seek to work in partnership with and remain accountable to the local church and mission organisation.

⁵⁷ <https://media.joshuaproject.net/public/assets/media/handouts/great-progress-what-remains.pdf> pg 8 Sharmin

⁵⁸ <https://lausanne.org/about/blog/business-as-mission-transforming-people-and-nations-for-gods-glory>

⁵⁹ <https://www.worldbank.org/en/brief/2023/11/07/afe-water>

⁶⁰ <https://www.who.int/publications/m/item/guidelines-for-drinking-water-quality--small-water-supplies--executive-summary>

⁶¹ <https://lausanne.org/about/blog/business-as-mission-transforming-people-and-nations-for-gods-glory>

⁶² <https://bamglobal.org/networks/>

⁶³ <https://transformationalsme.org/>

⁶⁴ <https://worldlightafrica.com/>

⁶⁵ <https://interserve.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2015/04/BAM.pdf>

⁶⁶ <https://businessasmission.com/engineering-on-the-frontlines-what-is-it-really-like-to-run-a-bam-business/>

I am intending to investigate this further and chat with missionaries, mission organisations, and potentially BAM networks.

5. Mission Organisations

Organisations differ fundamentally in their methods of engagement and priority regions. The similarities between the main Australian Mission Organisations are briefly investigated.

CMS (Church Missionary Society)

Focuses on long-term, cross-shaped ministry in partnership with local church authorities⁶⁷. Prioritises long-term immersion and partnership. The CMS strategy emphasises "supporting" rather than "usurping" local church authorities, focusing on areas with an existing (though perhaps small) ecclesiastical presence. Training whether that be theological education, or something else, is specialised to help local churches grow in maturity and reach their own communities.

SIM (Serving in Mission)

Emphasises "By Prayer" dependence, multicultural teams, and specialised "Faithful Witness" teams for regions where SIM has no prior presence⁶⁸. They also engage diaspora and migrant communities arriving to Australia through local church partnerships, such as English language classes⁶⁹. Operates major medical hubs such as the Galmi Hospital in Niger⁷⁰. There is a strong emphasis on pastoral member care, using spiritual and emotional health tools such as "Embracing Grace"⁷¹.

Pioneers

Focuses strictly on the "Pioneering" end of the spectrum, sending workers to UPGs where no local church currently exists. Prioritises church planting⁷² movements among UPGs using tools like Discovery Bible Studies (DBS)⁷³ to foster indigenous leadership. Encourages workers to deploy using their unique vocational skill sets⁷⁴.

Interserve

Utilises Wholistic Mission and Business-as-Mission (BAM)⁷⁵ to integrate professional skills with kingdom advancement in restricted-access areas utilising professional skills for intentional impact. Prepares workers for long-term presence in hard places where fruit takes

⁶⁷ <https://cms.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/CMS-Welcome-brochure-online.pdf>

⁶⁸ <https://sim.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Mission-Together-Issue-168.pdf>

⁶⁹ <https://sim.org.au/across/>

⁷⁰ <https://sim.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Mission-Together-Issue-168.pdf>

⁷¹ <https://sim.org.au/help-workers-thrive>

⁷² <https://pioneers.org.au/learn/church-planting/>

⁷³ The Most XLNT Way

⁷⁴ <https://pioneers.org.au/marketplace>

⁷⁵ <https://interserve.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2015/04/BAM.pdf>

time⁷⁶, measuring faithful stewardship through incarnational presence⁷⁷ and service with local churches rather than immediate decision counts.

OMF (Overseas Missionary Fellowship)

Committed to sharing the fullness of the gospel across East Asia and discipling East Asian returnees worldwide. Emphasises interactive training and simulates field realities through "Mission Workshops." They utilise tools like "Ups and Downs" (church planting simulations) and "Secret Message" (navigating hostile environments) to prepare candidates for the "Culture Shock" of subtle unspoken rules⁷⁸. Missional Theological Education, Christian literature and publishing such as Kanok Bannasan in Thailand⁷⁹, residential discipleship centres WMTC⁸⁰.

A key focus for all organisations is for missionaries to support existing local Churches. This involves working under local leadership to strengthen existing bodies, ensuring that power imbalances are managed and authority is not usurped. For organisations sending missionaries among UPGs, in areas with no existing church, the focus is on "pioneer" evangelism. This involves supporting missionaries as they are engaged in relational witness and profession-based entry.

6. Training and Maintaining

Preparing

Long-term missionary vocation should be tested through practical ministry rather than determined solely through personal conviction. Amongst the preliminary Gospel work experience opportunities like the Vocational Bible College (VBC) apprenticeship⁸¹ or the Scripture Union Internship⁸² the Ministry Training Strategy (MTS) Team Leader Apprenticeship seems most suitable for a mission focus. Because it provides a framework to test character, conviction, and competence⁸³ through sustained ministry exposure, it can be applied to many potential ministry vocations, including mission.

This apprenticeship functions as a period of testing before making a long-term commitment (like dating), exposing a candidate to the intensity of people-focused ministry and the realities of ministry that cannot be understood through theological study alone.

⁷⁶ <https://interserve.org.sg/about/values/>

⁷⁷ https://interserve.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2015/04/Gods_Big_Idea.pdf

⁷⁸ <https://cdn.omf.org.sg/files/20230622110853/Millions-Jan-Apr-2023.pdf>

⁷⁹ <https://eng.kanokbannasan.org/>

⁸⁰ <https://cdn.omf.org.sg/files/20230622110853/Millions-Jan-Apr-2023.pdf>

⁸¹ <https://www.vbc.edu.au/apprenticeships>

⁸² <https://su.org.au/internship/>

⁸³ <https://mts.com.au/the-3-cs-in-1-timothy-3/>

Roughly 31% apprentices enter full-time vocational ministry, while the remaining ~69% operate as "highly trained lay leaders" in local churches or corporate jobs. This is not a failure, but a feature.

More reading desired

<https://mts.com.au/how-god-is-growing-mts-throughout-the-world/>

<https://reachaustralia.com.au/how-many-mts-apprentices-end-up-in-full-time-ministry/>

Where long-term missionary service is discerned, practical ministry experience should be complemented by theological and cross-cultural education. During a ministry traineeship, formal connections with missionary organisations, such as Mission Track⁸⁴ with CMS, should be sought to network and gain a deeper sense of a mission team⁸⁵. Consequent formal theological/divinity education^{86 87 88} develops biblical and theological foundations, while further missiological study⁸⁹ can prepare those intending to teach or undertake more specialised cross-cultural work. Final preparation may include intensive missiological, language, cultural and security training before deployment. A potential pathway could therefore involve:

MTS (2028) → Theological education (2030) → Missiological preparation (2031) → Deployment (2032)

This is assuming no Graduate Engineering position is pursued. Both cases need consideration.

The following areas shall be investigated, not swayed by romanticised depictions, to focus on biblical principles lived out.

Going

...

Culture shock

<https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/themelios/review/crossing-cultures-with-the-gospel-anthropological-wisdom-for-effective-christian/>

The following [Potential 10/40 countries](#) can be considered

Staying

...

This is very dependent on the form of mission. Investigation into the reasoning behind the "10-year standard term" for deployment.

⁸⁴ <https://www.cms.org.au/nswact/missiontrack/>

⁸⁵ <https://www.imb.org/course-term/imb-missionary-missionary-team/>

⁸⁶ <https://www.smbc.edu.au/>

⁸⁷ <https://moore.edu.au/>

⁸⁸ <https://www.ridley.edu.au/>

⁸⁹ For example a 19-week course at St Andrew's Hall <https://www.cms.org.au/stories/in-depth-training-run-with-endurance/>

Check out <https://askamissionary.com/>

Leaving

...

In Chapter 6 of Too Valuable to Lose, Peter Brierley writes that one of the key findings of ReMAP is that each year the on-field mission force loses 5.1% of its workers. Of these, 71% leave for what are called "preventable reasons." These reasons are in contrast to non-preventable reasons, "such as normal retirement, a political crisis, death of a spouse, marriage outside the mission, or a change of job." (Craig Thompson 2014)⁹⁰

What are the positive and negative push and pull factors that missionaries face?

Further resources to evaluate, read, and consider:

<https://askamissionary.com/deciding-trip-length/>

<https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/article/tensions-missions-church-navigate/>

<https://www.alifeoverseas.com/what-is-the-average-length-of-service-for-missionaries-on-the-field-the-long-and-the-short-of-it/>

<https://www.epcwo.org/missionarymembercare/>

https://weamc.global/archive/Taylor_Too-Valuable-To-Lose.pdf

<https://clearingcustoms.net/2014/11/29/why-do-missionaries-leave-the-field-its-hard-to-say/>

<https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/abs/10.1177/2396939320966220?ref=modernmissions.life>

<https://omf.org/us/missionaries-get-lonely-too-its-contributing-to-missionary-attrition/>

https://www.worldevangelicals.org/resources/rfiles/res3_95_link_1292358708.pdf

<https://www.goserve love.net/why-missionaries-leave/>

<https://www.alifeoverseas.com/closer-to-the-truth-about-current-missionary-attrition-an-initial-analysis-of-results/>

<https://munsonmissions.org/2016/07/21/why-are-23-world-missionaries-quitting/>

<https://oscar.org.uk/articles/rest-renewal-for-mission-workers>

<https://internationalministries.org/sabbatical-rest/>

<https://www.alifeoverseas.com/too-much-member-care-can-there-be-such-a-thing/>

<https://tedesler.substack.com/p/missionary-attrition>

⁹⁰ <https://clearingcustoms.net/2014/11/29/why-do-missionaries-leave-the-field-its-hard-to-say/>

https://www.worldevangelicals.org/resources/rfiles/res3_95_link_1292358708.pdf

<https://propempo.com/community/propempo-blog/the-truth-about-missionary-attribution2/>

<https://omf.org/us/when-missionaries-regret-being-missionaries/>

<https://www.actioninternational.org/story/ten-problems-missionaries-face/>

<https://www.team.org/article/life-on-the-mission-field/>

7. Personal Assessment: Circumstances and the "CMS 10"

CMS has a helpful biblically based criterion⁹¹ to determine a person's suitability for vocational mission. Personal analysis of circumstances according to this criterion does not indicate a decision to associate with CMS or another Missionary Organisation yet. Suitability for vocational mission will be continually assessed.

1. **You have a mature Christian character and strong personal spiritual life:** I continue in ongoing growth in godliness and spiritual discipline. This is evidenced by active service and desire for continuous growth. An example of this is my ministry involvement and amateur theology writing, particularly "Knowing God"⁹².
2. **You and CMS agree in central areas of doctrinal commitment:** My beliefs align with CMS's understanding of God and how he works in the world.
3. **You have a clear, strong personal commitment to cross-cultural missionary service:** I am intentionally ready to subject the closeness and commitments to my family to mission.
4. **You have strong relational and interpersonal skills:** Demonstrated through Red Frogs, Food & Friends, and Bible Study leading; however, conflict management in intense cross-cultural settings remains untested. MTS will be a great opportunity for this.
5. **You share a clear "fit" with CMS values and ministry priorities:** I am in alignment with priority regions and support structures. Further familiarisations with the different missionary organisations shall assist in assessing this regard.
6. **You bring the committed endorsement and prayer support of local church(es):** It is anticipated that the support through prayer, connection and giving from the St Mark's congregation shall increase. MTS is a good way to test this.
7. **Your ministry skills have been tried and tested in your home context:** My prior and present ministry skills have been tested and can be further tested in an MTS position.
8. **You are healthy:** Currently, with Haemophilia B, I am physically resilient in an Australian environment because of access to Alprolix medication on the Australian Pharmaceutical Benefits Scheme (PBS). Due to Australian expats not having access

⁹¹ www.cms.org.au/nswact/get-involved/should-i-go/10-qualities-of-an-enquirer/

⁹² https://uowmail.edu-my.sharepoint.com/:w:/r/personal/jjw995_uowmail_edu_au/_layouts/15/Doc.aspx?sourcedoc=%7BCC0CFC2D-A335-4B5D-868B-603E8790349C%7D&file=What%20does%20it%20mean%20to%20know%20God.docx&action=default&mobileredirect=true

to the PBS, I am participating in the BEYOND-9 (REGV131-LNP1265) Clinical Trial⁹³. After being genetically engineered in January 2027, a non-intrusive [monitoring regime](#) should not affect a pathway to mission, and I would be effectively cured. Psychologically, my baseline is resilient, though I have sought some circumstantial counselling.

9. **You are content in your current relational status:** Whilst I am content in my singleness, I am desiring to know someone better and I am open to the possibility of relationship. Singleness offers significant opportunities at the cost of distinct barriers. For example, without the responsibilities associated with connection to marriage or family, greater availability to travel and set schedules around ministry demands is possible. However, the absence of such connections can intensify feelings of isolation, especially when there are often no opportunities to meet other single believers⁹⁴. Anecdotally, the lack of a "family witness" can be a taboo in some UPG contexts where family is the standard for "normalcy" in non-individualistic societies. All Christian families, even on home soil, should be mission focussed⁹⁵. Families involved in vocational mission have the responsibility of significant moral authenticity which is a significant witness in any community⁹⁶. A Christian can be a faithful witness (1COR 7) and barriers will still be faced in the formation of cross-cultural friendships⁹⁷ no matter a relationship status.
10. **You meet CMS education and training pre-requisites:** Following the completion of the Team Leader MTS at St Marks's Anglican, I will pursue formal theological/divinity education^{98 99 100} develops biblical and theological foundations, while further missiological study¹⁰¹ can prepare myself to teach or undertake more specialised cross-cultural work.

8. What next?

You learned it from Epaphras, our dear fellow servant, who is a faithful minister of Christ on our behalf, and who also told us of your love in the Spirit.

For this reason, since the day we heard about you, we have not stopped praying for you. We continually ask God to fill you with the knowledge of his will through all the wisdom and understanding that the Spirit gives, so that you may live a life worthy of the Lord and please him in every way: bearing fruit in every good work, growing in the knowledge of God, being strengthened with all power according to his glorious might so that you may have great endurance and patience, and giving joyful thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of his holy people in the kingdom of light. For he has rescued us from the dominion of darkness and brought us into the kingdom of the Son he loves, in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins.

⁹³ <https://hemophilia-beyond-9.com/en-au/>

⁹⁴ <https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/article/single-missionaries-not-alone/>

⁹⁵ <https://seedbed.com/becoming-a-missional-family-2/>

⁹⁶ <https://missionexus.org/uncategorized/an-ordinary-family-in-ministry/>

⁹⁷ <https://www.cms.org.au/stories/every-church-member-as-a-missionary/>

⁹⁸ <https://www.smbc.edu.au/>

⁹⁹ <https://moore.edu.au/>

¹⁰⁰ <https://www.ridley.edu.au/>

¹⁰¹ For example, 19-week at St Andrew's Hall <https://www.cms.org.au/stories/in-depth-training-run-with-endurance/>

Colossians 1:7-14

I will continue the steps along the journey for involvement in Ministry by learning from gospel workers, growing in my love of the Holy Spirit, knowledge of God's will, and understanding that the Holy Spirit gives. Through this I can glorify God in whichever place he plans for me to be, whether in vocational ministry or elsewhere. All of this is founded in what Jesus has done for me.

Currently, I believe that with consideration of Jesus' commission, the need for the Gospel around the world, and my circumstances, mission is not just something that is good and I could do, but something I should take the next steps for. At the 2025 St Mark's Considering Ministry event, I was neutrally curious towards ministry. The culmination of questions catalysed at the CO:MISSION event on the 23rd of February 2026. There, I distinctively realised that I should actively pursue vocational ministry, particularly mission. I have chatted with Alex Zunica, Jordan Smith, Craig Thompspon around July. I have inquired further at the 2026 St Marks Considering Ministry and the CMS Narellan Mission Up Close event. I started this document on the 13th of August 2026. I will pursue contact with MTS coordinators (Daniel Morris) and potentially CMS leadership (John Lovel) if I do Mission Track¹⁰².

I started learning Arabic¹⁰³ on the 18th August 2026. Prior to the Mission-Minded/All For the Kingdom¹⁰⁴ Conference on the weekend of the 25th of September 2026, I will continue collating questions and read *Zeal without Burnout*¹⁰⁵. Afterwards, I would be interested in chatting with Margaret Brain, given her wisdom and experience on the mission field in Tanzania and the Democratic Republic of Congo. Given my inclination towards BAM, I am interested in chatting with AJ & K¹⁰⁶ from Pioneers, gaining their insight on BAM. Generally, I will engage current missionaries (AJ, K, Craig, Belinda) via email and call to discuss the reality of the "Invisible Team" and field isolation. Onwards, I would like to be in consultation with a Missionary Organisation as I evaluate whether I should have Graduate Engineering Experience Prior to MTS.

I'm weighing up lots of perspectives.

<https://st-eutychus.com/2009/five-reasons-im-not-doing-mts/>

<https://ministryprinciples.com/2018/01/30/people-dont-do-mts/>

I would love to continue in my current ministry commitments, particularly the Red Frogs November the 21st to December the 11th schoolies trip to Fiji. Outside the primary responsibilities in Fiji, I am interested in observing ministry in an unfamiliar cultural context. Semi Lutu's is Craig Thompsons mate, and perhaps I could visit the Church he leads.

My intention for 2027 is to prioritise my preparation for a potential Team Leader MTS position at St Marks. Given that I graduate (God-willing) with a Bachelor of Mechatronic Engineering (Honours) at the end of 2027, I will continue my Engineering Project¹⁰⁷ and

¹⁰² <https://www.cms.org.au/nswact/missiontrack/>

¹⁰³ <https://missionexus.org/articles/from-hello-to-heart-the-missionarys-guide-to-learning-a-foreign-language/>

¹⁰⁴ <https://allforthe kingdom.org/>

¹⁰⁵ <https://www.thegoodbook.com.au/zeal-without-burnout-tf/>

¹⁰⁶ <https://stmarkswww.my.canva.site/gospelpartners/people>

¹⁰⁷ <https://jonowalsh.net/projects/MESH.html>

apply for a graduate role¹⁰⁸ in the National Security Industry¹⁰⁹. Whilst a financial burden and wanting to not be "out of touch" can motivate an MTS candidate to pursue work prior to MTS, I believe both issues can be addressed responsibly in the immediate MTS commencement route. Though I will prepare for both, upon further consultation with wise Christians and research, I shall decide in the middle of 2027 whether I commence an MTS immediately in 2028 or after a graduate role.

<https://businessasmission.com/start/pathways/>

<https://businessasmission.com/pathways-into-bam-resources-for-your-journey/>

<https://www.thestonetable.org/top-10-bam-books-roadmap-to-business-as-mission-success/>

Regarding health that God affords me, after the intensive monitoring period over the next two years in the [Beyond-9 Monitoring Regime](#), I would be physiologically normal. I can opt in for yearly checkups in the 15-year period, but I'll cross that bridge when I get there.

I will continue praying, reading God's word, chatting, researching, and prioritising cognisance of the mission field both past¹¹⁰ and present.

Conclusion

Missionary service is one way of faithfully serving Jesus, but it is not the only way; vocational ministry is a privilege, not a requirement for a dedicated Christian life. Personal ambitions and a career in engineering can exist alongside faithful Christian service¹¹¹ Christian identity ultimately rests not on professional achievement, missionary success, or measurable results, but on belonging to Christ. Therefore, I will ask, seek, and knock (MATT 7:7-12), trusting God to make my paths straight as I submit my life to His priorities. My hope is ultimately to see people from every nation and language worshipping God together (REV 5:9-13), while faithfully fulfilling the covenantal calling to witness to Christ and His established rule (REV 1:5; PSA 89).

Appendix

Potential 10/40 Countries

Countries of Mission priority (within the 10/40 window¹¹²) and with feasible employment conditions (not ITAR prohibited §126.1 and Australian diplomatic presence, see [personal circumstances](#)) have been identified. This is Informed by the DFAT113, the Cornell Law School114, and the List of countries and dependencies by population¹¹⁵.

¹⁰⁸ <https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1IWwKELbH8nwt0Y1GdRSRtu8yngYWBzGQcOX9UY-PML0/edit?gid=0#gid=0>

¹⁰⁹ <https://sciencenetwork.uk/think/can-christians-work-in-the-arms-industry>

¹¹⁰ <https://www.smbc.edu.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/07/out-of-darkness-chapter-10.pdf>

¹¹¹ <https://in.thegospelcoalition.org/article/ambition-contentment/>

¹¹² https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/10/40_window

¹¹³ <https://www.dfat.gov.au/about-us/our-locations/missions/our-embassies-and-consulates-overseas>

¹¹⁴ <https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/22/126.1>

¹¹⁵ https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_countries_and_dependencies_by_population

Australian Diplomatic Office & Not ITAR prohibited (Most Preferable)	Australian Diplomatic Office & ITAR prohibited (More Preferable)	Not Australian Diplomatic Office & ITAR prohibited (Less Preferable)	Not Australian Diplomatic Office & Not ITAR prohibited (Least Preferable)
Bangladesh	China	Algeria	Afghanistan
Cambodia	Ethiopia	Bahrain	Eritrea
Egypt	Iran	Benin	North Korea
India	Iraq	Bhutan	Libya
Israel	Lebanon	Burkina Faso	Sudan
Japan	Myanmar	Chad	Syria
Jordan	Cyprus	Djibouti	Yemen
Kuwait		Gambia	
Laos		Guinea	
Malta		Guinea-Bissau	
Morocco		Mali	
Nepal		Mauritania	
Oman		Senegal	
Pakistan		Tajikistan	
Qatar		Turkmenistan	
Saudi Arabia		Tunisia	
Thailand		Taiwan	
Türkiye		Western Sahara	
United Arab Emirates			
Vietnam			

Australian Diplomatic Office & Not ITAR prohibited(Most Preferable)	Population	Australian Diplomatic Office & ITAR prohibited(More Preferable)	Population	No Australian Diplomatic Office & ITAR prohibited(Less Preferable)	Population	No Australian Diplomatic Office & Not ITAR prohibited(Least Preferable)	Population
Bangladesh	169,828,911	China	1,404,890,000	Algeria	47,400,000	Afghanistan	43,844,000
Cambodia	17,816,143	Ethiopia	111,652,998	Bahrain	1,603,260	Eritrea	3,682,669
Egypt	108,613,296	Iran	87,134,000	Benin	13,551,992	North Korea	25,950,000
India	1,429,404,000	Iraq	46,118,793	Bhutan	784,043	Libya	7,539,852
Israel	10,273,700	Lebanon	5,895,466	Burkina Faso	24,736,828	Sudan	53,282,719
Japan	122,680,000	Myanmar	51,375,327	Chad	20,031,602	Syria	26,472,497
Jordan	11,937,000	Cyprus*	983,000	Djibouti	1,066,809	Yemen	32,684,503
Kuwait	4,881,254			Gambia	2,422,712		
Laos	7,745,000			Guinea	17,521,167		
Malta	588,254			Guinea-Bissau	1,890,252		
Morocco	37,254,695			Mali	23,929,000		
Nepal	30,034,040			Mauritania	4,927,532		
Oman	5,398,645			Senegal	19,575,061		
Pakistan	241,499,431			Tajikistan	10,721,000		
Qatar	3,370,611			Turkmenistan	7,057,841		
Saudi Arabia	35,300,280			Tunisia	11,992,843		
Thailand	70,250,751			Taiwan†	23,235,002		
Türkiye	86,092,168			Western Sahara	610,813		
United Arab Emirates	11,294,243			Vietnam	102,300,000		
TOTAL: 19 countries	2,404,262,422	TOTAL: 7 countries	1,708,049,584	TOTAL: 19 countries	335,357,757	TOTAL: 7 countries	193,456,240

Beyond-9 Monitoring Regime

Visit #	Phase	Visit Date
1	Admission / Dosing	15-Jan-2027
2	Weekly follow-up	22-Jan-2027
3	Weekly follow-up	29-Jan-2027
4	Weekly follow-up	05-Feb-2027
5	Weekly follow-up	12-Feb-2027
6	Twice-weekly follow-up	15-Feb-2027
7	Twice-weekly follow-up	19-Feb-2027
8	Twice-weekly follow-up	22-Feb-2027
9	Twice-weekly follow-up	26-Feb-2027
10	Twice-weekly follow-up	01-Mar-2027
11	Twice-weekly follow-up	05-Mar-2027
12	Twice-weekly follow-up	08-Mar-2027
13	Twice-weekly follow-up	12-Mar-2027
14	Twice-weekly follow-up	15-Mar-2027
15	Twice-weekly follow-up	19-Mar-2027
16	Twice-weekly follow-up	22-Mar-2027
17	Twice-weekly follow-up	26-Mar-2027
18	Twice-weekly follow-up	29-Mar-2027
19	Twice-weekly follow-up	02-Apr-2027
20	Twice-weekly follow-up	05-Apr-2027
21	Twice-weekly follow-up	09-Apr-2027
22	Twice-weekly follow-up	12-Apr-2027
23	Monthly follow-up	15-May-2027
24	Monthly follow-up	15-Jun-2027
25	Monthly follow-up	15-Jul-2027
26	3-monthly follow-up	15-Oct-2027
27	3-monthly follow-up	15-Jan-2028
28	3-monthly follow-up	15-Apr-2028
29	3-monthly follow-up	15-Jul-2028
30	3-monthly follow-up	15-Oct-2028
31	3-monthly follow-up (Year 2 End)	15-Jan-2029
32	Long-term follow-up (6-monthly)	15-Jul-2029

33	Long-term follow-up (6-monthly)	15-Jan-2030
34	Long-term follow-up (6-monthly)	15-Jul-2030
35	Long-term follow-up (6-monthly)	15-Jan-2031
36	Long-term follow-up (6-monthly)	15-Jul-2031
37	Long-term follow-up (6-monthly)	15-Jan-2032
38	Annual long-term follow-up	15-Jan-2033
39	Annual long-term follow-up	15-Jan-2034
40	Annual long-term follow-up	15-Jan-2035
41	Annual long-term follow-up	15-Jan-2036
42	Annual long-term follow-up	15-Jan-2037
43	Annual long-term follow-up	15-Jan-2038

End of document